A new Cold War

China's relations were the reverse of India's relations with the US during this period. As Chinese power grew, Washington pivoted to Asia to restore American influence. In 2016, it helped launch the Trans-Pacific Partnership with eleven other Pacific Rim countries. Economic tensions, primarily over Chinese intellectual property theft and over China's huge trade surpluses with the US, continued to damage relations. Chinese military facilities on reefs and atolls in the South China Sea rang alarm bells in the region and in Washington. In 2017, the US National Security Report pointed to China (along with Russia) as the main threats to the US. In 2018, Washington announced a series of tariffs on Chinese goods which led Beijing to retaliate. The arrest of the Chinese computer giant Huawei's chief financial officer, Meng Wenzhou, in Canada at American instigation led to a further deterioration in relations. Despite the 'phase one' China–US trade deal in January 2020, relations worsened over US accusations that China was a currency manipulator, Washington's support of the pro-democracy movement in Hong Kong, and Beijing's initial response to the Covid-19 pandemic.

China–Russia relations, like India–Russia relations, were built around military and energy sales. Despite unauthorized Chinese copying of Russian arms, Moscow continued to pursue an alliance-like relationship, selling the S-400 missile system, infantry vehicles, and helicopters, and cooperating in the development of space capabilities and China's FGFA. In 2019, it agreed to work with China on an anti-missile warning system that would provide information on a possible US attack. As Chinese technology improved, the cooperation was increasingly a two-way street. The two militaries exercised extensively on sea and on land, laying the foundation for greater interoperability. Hundreds of Chinese officers were trained in Russia. At the diplomatic level, Beijing and Moscow were largely in agreement on global issues and cast several joint vetoes in the UN. Bilateral trade went from $57 billion in 2008 to $84 billion in 2017.[44] Energy cooperation expanded, with sales and joint construction of pipelines from Russia to China leading to a